

A step-by-step guide

Land Your First Job

From search to hired.

Turn your preparation into real applications, interviews and offers.

8
steps

30
day plan

1
job offer

8 steps to hired.

Read one step. Do the action. Move on.

01

Know Your Target

Aim before you apply.

02

Build Your Resume

One page. One story.

03

Polish Your Presence

Be easy to find. Easy to like.

04

Find the Openings

Look in more places.

05

Apply Smart

Fewer, better applications.

06

Network Without Awkwardness

Ask for advice, not a job.

07

Ace the Interview

Prepare stories, not scripts.

08

Get the Offer

Decide with confidence.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Take one step every 2 to 3 days. Finish the action box before you turn the page. Track everything on the last page.

01

Know Your Target

Aim before you apply.

Pick 3 target roles

- Read 20 job posts for roles you like.
- Note the skills that keep repeating.
- Choose roles you could do within 6 months.

List your proof

- Projects, internships, coursework, clubs, volunteering.
- For each, write what you did and what changed.

Choose your lane

- Industry, location or remote, company size.
- Narrow choices beat endless scrolling.

DO THIS TODAY

Write 3 job titles on a sticky note. Save 5 matching job posts for each.

Build Your Resume

One page. One story.

The 5 sections

- Header with contact details and links.
- Two-line summary.
- Education.
- Projects or experience.
- Skills.

The bullet formula

- Action verb + what you did + the result.
- Example: Built a budget tracker for 40 classmates and cut planning time by 30%.

Avoid these

- Photos and heavy graphics.
- Dense paragraphs and typos.
- The phrase “responsible for”.
- One resume sent to every job.

DO THIS TODAY

Draft your resume, then tailor a version to one saved job post. Save it as FirstName_LastName.pdf.

Polish Your Presence

Be easy to find. Easy to like.

LinkedIn in 4 parts

- Clear, friendly photo.
- Headline: your target role + top skills.
- Three-line About section.
- Featured projects.

Show your work

- Pick your 2 or 3 best projects.
- Write the problem, your role and the result.
- Link them from your resume.

Clean-up check

- Google your own name.
- Use a professional email address.
- Make public profiles match your story.

DO THIS TODAY

Rewrite your LinkedIn headline. Ask a friend if your goal is obvious in 5 seconds.

04

Find the Openings

Look in more places.

Where to look

- Job boards: LinkedIn, Indeed, Glassdoor.
- Company career pages.
- College placement cell and alumni.
- Hiring communities and job fairs.

Search smarter

- Search role title + one key skill.
- Set daily alerts.
- Filter for entry-level and recent posts.

Move fast

- Apply within 48 hours of posting.
- Save every post in your tracker.
- Note each closing date.

DO THIS TODAY

Set up 3 job alerts. List 10 companies you would love to join.

Apply Smart

Fewer, better applications.

The 5-step apply loop

- Read the post closely.
- Match it to your proof.
- Tailor your resume.
- Apply.
- Track it.

Cover note in 3 lines

- Hook: why this company.
- Proof: your best match for the role.
- Ask: invite a conversation.

Before you hit submit

- Names and company spelling are right.
- Keywords from the post are included.
- The PDF opens and contact details are correct.

DO THIS TODAY

Send 10 tailored applications this week. Log each one in your tracker (last page).

Network Without Awkwardness

Ask for advice, not a job.

Who to message

- Alumni and seniors.
- Friends of friends.
- Recruiters and hiring managers.
- Speakers from events you attended.

A message that works

"Hi [Name], I'm a [degree] graduate exploring [role]. I liked your path to [company]. Could I ask you two quick questions?"

Keep it going

- Follow up once after 5 to 7 days.
- Thank every person who helps.
- Aim for 3 conversations a week.

DO THIS TODAY

Send 5 messages today. Keep them short and specific.

Ace the Interview

Prepare stories, not scripts.

Prep your stories (STAR)

- Situation: set the scene.
- Task: your goal.
- Action: what you did.
- Result: what changed.

Practise these

- Tell me about yourself.
- Why this role and company?
- Describe a challenge you handled.
- Your strengths and areas to grow.

Interview day

- Test your tech or route early.
- Arrive 10 minutes early.
- Ask 2 smart questions.
- Send a thank-you within 24 hours.

DO THIS TODAY

Write 5 STAR stories. Say each one out loud twice.

Get the Offer

Decide with confidence.

When it arrives

- Say thanks and ask for time to review.
- Check salary, role, notice period and benefits.
- Get everything in writing.

Negotiate politely

- Research the typical range first.
- Ask: "Is there flexibility on the offer?"
- Weigh growth, learning and team, not just pay.

If you hear no

- Ask for feedback.
- Write down what you learned.
- Keep applying. Every no is data.

DO THIS TODAY

Compare offers on 3 points: growth, pay and people. Then choose.

YOUR PLAN

30 days. 4 weeks.

Tick each box as you go.

Week 1: Foundation

- ☐ Finish Steps 1 to 3
- ☐ Resume version 1 is done
- ☐ LinkedIn is updated

Week 2: Launch

- ☐ Set up job alerts
- ☐ Send 10 tailored applications
- ☐ List 10 target companies

Week 3: Connect

- ☐ Send 15 networking messages
- ☐ Hold 3 conversations
- ☐ Send 10 more applications

Week 4: Interview

- ☐ Write 5 STAR stories
- ☐ Do 2 mock interviews
- ☐ Follow up on every application

REMEMBER

Consistency beats intensity. A little progress every day gets you hired faster than a burst once a month.

TRACKER

Track every move.

Log each application, then follow up.

Company	Role	Applied	Status	Next step

YOU'VE GOT THIS

Now go get hired.